

Leadership by the New Nature

Last week, we got into why God had to choose a nation. He chose a nation to give the law to. The Word says, "By the law is the knowledge of sin."

So we had to go back a ways and take it through, laying the foundation for a little more intense study of our freedom: just how free you and I have been made.

There are incredible verses in Romans 6:

"Sin shall not have dominion over you:
for ye are not under the law,
but under grace."

Because of this, sin has lost its dominion over you and me. It does not have dominion. God condemned sin in the flesh. He condemned it.

All disease, sickness, and everything outside of our inheritance is a result of the fall, and all of it has been condemned. All of it.

Walking it out is an incredible thing. The closer I get to walking in what He has provided for us and in what the Word says, I am finding out I am graduating from employee to servant to slave. And the devil really does not bother you much until you are a slave. Then, if you do not get past him, you will not have anything.

The Lord told me one day, a long time ago, "Unless you get past his worst." He said, "Do you not understand where revival lives? You have to get past his worst."

I do not care. Hallelujah.

Paul was ministering to a Jewish community in Rome. As you know, in the seventh chapter he says, "I speak to those who know the law." He had been giving the position of the people who received the law, which is the Jewish nation.

Actually, we went back to the early world in the first chapter, the second chapter, the third, and the fourth. But these Jews were having problems accepting the fact that these swine-eating Gentiles, who had never kept a day of the law in their lives, were suddenly inheriting and becoming Abraham's seed. They were having problems with this.

So this whole book, and in fact many of the follow-up books such as Galatians, Ephesians, and Colossians, deal with places where the Judaizers had gone. Paul had to give the Church back her foundation because they were saying the Gentile could be saved, yes, and that he was the seed of Abraham, but that he would not be perfected until he went on to keep the law. That was Judaism, or the doctrine of the Judaizers.

Paul was addressing this problem to the Roman church, and then to Galatia and Colossae. Philippi, too, close to Philip with an "i." He was addressing this problem.

So here in this second chapter, after generally covering the state of fallen man before the flood and immediately after, Paul began to explain how the law could not save them. By the law was the knowledge of sin.

That is why Paul cried out in the seventh chapter, hypothetically putting himself in the position of every spiritually dead man, every spiritually dead Jew who received the law and could not keep it. They could keep it through sacrifice and ordinances, but they could not keep it through the new nature.

Paul says, "Is the law sin?" And he answers his own question in Romans 7:

"God forbid.
Nay, I had not known sin,
but by the law:
for I had not known lust,
except the law had said,
Thou shalt not covet."

How could you know anything else when you are born with that nature? A man born with the sin nature has no way of knowing anything outside of that. You have that nature because it is the core and power of what you are. You cannot be anything else when you are spiritually dead, because that is what you are.

Romans 7 is a classic chapter. Paul goes on to explain the dilemma of a spiritually dead man who received the Ten Commandments and could not keep them. That is the whole reason for animal sacrifice. It allowed God to operate with a covenant people until the promise came into effect, which was the inheritance of the seed, which was actually us being born again.

Paul says:

"Is the law sin? God forbid.
Nay, I had not known sin,
but by the law:
for I had not known lust,
except the law had said,
Thou shalt not covet."

Then he says, in essence, "The good that I would do, I cannot do; and the evil that I would not do, I end up doing."

He explains:

"It is no more I that do it,
but sin that dwelleth in me."

He is talking about that nature.

People will use this to separate the acts of their flesh from what they call their righteous spirit and say, "The acts of my flesh are independent of my righteous spirit. My righteousness is independent of my flesh."

Well, it is, but it is not independent of your deeds. God's gift to you was His righteousness. Your gift to Him is holiness. Hallelujah. Glory be to God forever.

When Paul said, "It is no more I that do it, but sin that dwelleth in me," this is what he was saying: "As a Jew, I received the Ten Commandments. With my mind, I acknowledge what they say. I know what they say, and I want to keep them. But I cannot, because the good that I would do, I cannot do, and the evil that I refuse to do, I end up doing. So it is no more I that do it, because I want to do what it says. It is that nature that dwells in me."

Thank God what stopped all of that was the graduation from Romans 7 to Romans 8, when Paul says:

"There is therefore now no condemnation
to them which are in Christ Jesus,
who walk not after the flesh,
but after the Spirit."

He is saying, "There is therefore now no more of these condemning sentences," that is, no more of a spiritually dead man receiving the law and being unable to keep it. There is now no more of this kind of condemnation to those who are in Christ Jesus, who have been born again, who walk no longer after that unregenerated nature, but after the born-again spirit.

Hallelujah. You just do not know how free you have been made.

Can you imagine Paul trying to establish this with these Jews at Rome? This is what Romans 2:13-14 is all about:

"For not the hearers of the law are just before God,
but the doers of the law shall be justified."

This is not "break the Ten Commandments and kill an animal to cover it." Here Paul is talking about being able to keep the law by the new nature.

Again:

"For not the hearers of the law are just before God,
but the doers of the law shall be justified."

Now, it would be easy to interpret "a doer of the law" as, "I am a Jew who received the Ten Commandments, and I am doing all the animal sacrifices like I am supposed to." That is one kind of doer of the law, and there is a righteousness which is by the law. But it was a kind of righteousness waiting for the promise. It was counted as righteousness, not the real thing as in the new nature.

This helps you understand another verse we covered two or three Sundays ago, Romans 3:20. It sounds like a contradiction of Romans 2:13, but it is not.

Romans 3:20 says:

"Therefore by the deeds of the law
there shall no flesh be justified in his sight:
for by the law is the knowledge of sin."

So in Romans 3:20, Paul says that by the deeds of the law no flesh can ever be justified in God's sight. Yet back in Romans 2:13, he says:

"For not the hearers of the law are just before God,
but the doers of the law shall be justified."

Which one of these contradictions is right? Of course, you would know if you assimilated the whole book.

The doers he is talking about in Romans 2 are those who have been born again and are able to keep the Ten Commandments out of the new nature. That is why, in the next verse, he explains why a Gentile can be saved.

Notice verses 13 and 14:

"For not the hearers of the law are just before God,
but the doers of the law shall be justified.
For when the Gentiles,
which have not the law,
do by nature the things contained in the law,
these, having not the law,
are a law unto themselves."

"For" is a conjunction that ties two thoughts together. Why would he say, "For when the Gentiles," unless he was tying two thoughts together?

The thoughts he is tying together are verses 13 and 14. It is not the hearers of the law who are just before God, but the doers of the law who shall be justified. For when the Gentiles, who do not have the law, do by new nature the things contained in that law, these having no law become a law unto themselves.

The Ten Commandments are literally a description of the new nature. That is why a spiritually dead man could not keep them.

Now Paul says a Gentile who does not have the law does by new nature the things contained within the law. He goes on to say they become a law unto themselves.

In other words, you do not have to preach to me again, "Do not commit adultery," because the nature inside of me says, "You do not have to commit it." Something inside of me says lying is wrong. Something inside of me says stealing is wrong. Covetousness is wrong.

Why? Because this law has been written in my heart now in a new nature. That is the covenant He said He would make with us after those days:

"I will put my laws into their mind,
and write them in their hearts:
and their sins and their iniquities
will I remember no more."

I have been set free.

Romans 2:14-15 says:

"For when the Gentiles,
which have not the law,
do by nature the things contained in the law,
these, having not the law,
are a law unto themselves:
which shew the work of the law written in their hearts,
their conscience also bearing witness,
and their thoughts the mean while accusing
or else excusing one another."

This is the system we are going to be judged by. Look at the next verse:

"In the day when God shall judge
the secrets of men by Jesus Christ
according to my gospel."

Here is the whole standard you are going to be judged by: not by law, but by conscience, by new nature. You need to walk your whole life by that now, the new nature.

Paul says your thoughts meanwhile accuse or excuse one another. That means there is no thought that comes from me, the devil, my flesh, circumstances, or anything else that is wrong, immoral, or outside of God, that my thoughts do not either accuse or excuse.

Anything my new nature accuses, I myself will not excuse. Hallelujah.

That is the whole standard you walk by now. That is what you are going to be judged by.

"I did not know that was wrong."

You had better hope, for your sake, that you are not lying.

That is where you start cutting fellowship.

The more I notice about Paul's walk, the more I see that the one thing he was concerned about near the end of his ministry more than anything else was how he walked pure and free from the blood and the conscience of all men. This was the hardest thing he was striving for.

I know what he wanted. I know now. When he stood before Jesus, he did not want any single thing in him to be alive that his new nature, that conscience, had ever accused. Not one thing.

Thank God for a walk like that.

When you are born again and your human spirit receives that new nature that freed you from sin, suddenly you get this consciousness that has morals to it. The law becomes a law unto itself. Nobody has to get up and quote the Ten Commandments, because they became alive in my morals.

Paul is saying that if the Gentile can keep the Ten Commandments by the new nature, and you, a Jew who received it by birth and circumcision, cannot, then does this not become true circumcision to the Gentile? Do they not become the true seed of Abraham, circumcised in spirit and not in flesh, through the cutting away of the old man?

By the time he gets to the end of Romans 2, this is exactly what he is saying:

"For he is not a Jew,
which is one outwardly;
neither is that circumcision,
which is outward in the flesh:
but he is a Jew,
which is one inwardly;
and circumcision is that of the heart,
in the spirit,
and not in the letter;
whose praise is not of men,
but of God."

Hello, seed of Abraham. Glory be to God. Hallelujah.

Who is the real Jew here?

When you were born again, this happened to your human spirit, my friend. He took the old sin nature out and gave you a new one. It is this new one that can accuse.

Somebody went out and made a bumper sticker real quick. It says, "What my new nature excuses, I do not accuse. What my new nature accuses, I do not excuse."

I think that is a good bumper sticker. I can just see everybody looking at it: "What?" It fit good at the prayer center.

What my new nature accuses, I am striving to get to the place where I will not excuse. I wish I were there. I am just not quite.

How do you know?

I proved it yesterday. Hallelujah.

When you go on extended fasts, especially when you get out on these outer limbs of change, and when you quit hiding from certain areas of the flesh, He starts getting into areas everybody else is doing already. You think, "Well, they are doing it."

He says, "Well, I thought you wanted to go all the way."

When I was born again, that happened to me, to my person. My human spirit is one person. The Holy Spirit is another.

What my human spirit received is what is right and wrong. But as far as my own personal human spirit, I have no way of knowing anything outside of myself. I am a person.

Step out of your body, and you are walking around heaven. You have clothes on, eyeballs, teeth, a mouth, and you eat, even though you are spirit. Your body is lying there somewhere, just lying there, not looking too good. You are running around heaven as a person. You have hands, eyes, feet, a nose, and a mouth.

You are born again now, but your human spirit is no more supernatural now than it will be in heaven. That is why I am a contained person. I have no way of knowing anything outside of myself when it just comes to my human spirit.

But what I do have is a conscience now that excuses, accuses, and condemns sin. I do know what is right and wrong. I do know that much.

Now, I do not know how to know anything outside of myself, such as in Hebrews when it says:

"Strong meat belongeth to them that are of full age,
even those who by reason of use
have their senses exercised
to discern both good and evil."

Sometimes good needs to be discerned. The reason good will need to be discerned is because sometimes good is cloaking evil. Outside of yourself, you cannot tell, because you are a self-contained person.

Sometimes somebody will fall into a pattern you have seen before, and you start getting an uneasy feeling. "Where is this going?" Because you have been there before. But that is through deduction and patterns.

As far as absolutely knowing when evil is being cloaked by good, and it all appears very good outside of myself, I have no way of knowing.

You know, when Mr. Right or Mrs. Right comes along and they are everything you ever dreamed of, there is just one problem: wait until their Eastern roots take over and they start telling you what you will eat and when you will eat it.

I wish I had known this before I was married. I just wish I had known it.

The flesh can restrain itself pretty good. If it has to contain itself, it can do that for a period of time. It is like the guy who says, "Deliver me from women." When he opened his eyes, he had been translated to a desert island where there were not any.

That is like the guy you tie up in the chair and say, "We have solved your problem. You cannot get loose, so you cannot sin."

He says, "Yes, my body may be tied up, but I am sinning inside."

That is the problem.

Most of us can restrain our flesh pretty well through periods of time. But when it is no longer conducive to restrain it, in other words, when the knot is tied, there is no use being Mr. Nice Guy anymore. Yet at home is where you should be the picture of Christ.

We are real nice to people we run into in the workplace, the market, and the mall, and the real rascal comes out at home. It should be the opposite.

If you are going to be mean to anybody, why the people you love?

"Because I can get by with it."

My point exactly.

With my conscience, it is hard for me to judge outside of myself. That is why He sent the Holy Spirit. He knows everything.

In the first level of the leadership of the Spirit, listen closely, the first level, when He bears witness, the inner witness, the only thing He has to use is your conscience.

So you are standing there looking at Mr. Wonderful. He has a pound of gel in his hair. He is the modern look. He is perfect. He is everything. "Mama, Mama, I have met Mr. Right. You just cannot believe it."

All of a sudden, the Holy Spirit rises up. Even though his lips get there two minutes before he does because he wants to smooch you so badly, he is it. Mr. Right.

But the Holy Ghost rises up in there and condemns the whole thing. The only thing He has to use is your new nature to do it with.

My conscience meanwhile bearing witness, my thoughts accusing or excusing one another.

So He jumps in there and says, "Look, I am supernatural. I know the beginning from the end, and you are going to have a bad end." He rises up, but unfortunately the only thing He has to use in the beginning of our leadership of the Spirit is your conscience. He does not have two things to use. He has one thing: your conscience.

He will either excuse the situation or He will condemn it. He will rise up and go wild in your conscience, and you are going, "But look at him. He is a dreamboat. All my girlfriends are going to chew their fingernails off when they see him."

You will keep going and keep going until you talk yourself out of it. Then you will not even take hindsight as a teacher. Two kids, a job, and a babysitter later, and you are paying for his gel now.

Here is what most of us do. This is why the Body of Christ is in such a mess.

Do you think they are walking by their conscience? Do you think a lot of our leaders did not have to sear a lot of things and go against the Holy Spirit to get dead in some of the areas of what they are saying and where their lives are going?

When you just go serve yourself, and I serve myself, do you think achievement is making it to church? When you serve yourself and sear your conscience, then some wrong situation presents itself, and you have not been walking and doing what He said or trying to follow Him, do you think you are going to hear?

I have walked after myself so long, and He wants to block this situation? What have I done to my conscience?

Hallelujah.

You learn to walk by that inner witness. There are three other tremendous ways He communicates with His children.

He will give you visions. He will speak to you directly in your spirit. He will communicate by revelations, my favorite.

In revelation, He will capsule up a whole revelation on a computer chip, send it to my spirit, and release the whole program in a milligram of a second. Suddenly I receive enough in a second that it will take me months to preach. He can communicate like that over a problem. Suddenly you know how to solve your whole business problem from top to bottom.

It is wonderful when He starts walking like that.

I learned how to hear His voice from meditating His Word. Then, when my conscience would be seared in certain areas, because I loved God and wanted to come out of it, I gave myself to fasting and prayer. When that part of me began to wake up and got stronger than the flesh, it condemned it, and it died. I had no problem anymore.

Hallelujah.

If something starts happening to your hunger for the Word of God, you are already getting yourself in trouble.

One reason we do not like to go to a church that is alive, full of the Holy Ghost, and full of revelation knowledge, is because we are working on searing some area we do not want to approach. You have to make yourself go to a good church, where they worship, the Word is good, and everything is high. By the end of the service, you have to admit you were kind of glad you went.

But when you have to make yourself go, something is happening to your fellowship.

The more I walk according to that excusing or accusing, the more accurate I am going to be, the more my life is going to follow Him, and the more glorious it gets. Hallelujah.

So I listen closely now.

I have found out that a lot of times, when I meet somebody and say, "How are you doing?" immediately the Holy Ghost sometimes rises up and takes my conscience and accuses. All of a sudden my conscience bears witness that something is wrong.

I just took them by the hand, for God's sake. Or sometimes it happens just when they come into my presence.

If I listen to that and say, "Okay, all right, I am going to store this. I know something is wrong," many times, when I acknowledge it, He will follow it up by revelation. He will send a capsule across, and it will explode in my spirit. All of a sudden, I will know a good deal about them.

Not the kind of details you would think, but the serious patterns they have set for their life that are causing the problems they have, whether it be lust, backsliding, or being a hypocrite living another lifestyle. Suddenly I will know the patterns. I do not know details, like the color of their wife's eyes. Hallelujah.

If I walk by that conscience when He condemns it, I am starting to find out that no matter what it costs me, if He says no inside, I say no. I will not get on the plane. I will not go do it. If He says no, I will not do it.

Now sometimes it is funny. He will leave it up to me. "If you want to go, great. If you do not, it is okay. It is acceptable with Me if you want to go."

But anymore, if He condemns it by the inner witness, you just cannot make me do it. It costs too much. The end is not going to be good. So I will not do it.

One of my hardest tests came when Brother Dhinakaran was working on a meeting.

You have to understand, if Brother Dhinakaran gets the person and sets this big open-air meeting up, for \$25,000 you can have a meeting that would cost anybody else \$100,000, because his name is national. When he sanctions something, everybody comes pouring out.

He is the one I had the crusade with where 200,000 were born again one night, and 5,000 people's teeth were filled with silver and gold in one mass prayer.

Anyway, he was in India preaching the preachers' conference, and he asked if we could come to the college. We went over to the college. He said, "I am setting you up. Would you like me to work on this meeting and set this meeting up for you?"

He was setting up an open-air meeting. It would have been massive.

In my spirit, the Holy Spirit rose up with my conscience and said, "No."

You have to understand, Brother Dhinakaran is a man of compassion. He comes into your presence and you feel like crying. You just want to cry and do not even know why. You just break down and bawl.

Anyway, I was sitting there crying, and I was so overwhelmed by the presence of everything. After that meeting that we had, Brother Dhinakaran had been to our church, so he knew what stage of dying I was in. I preached a preachers' conference with him in America, so he knew.

He ministered by television and radio to almost a billion people a month. His crusades were half a million and larger, and he was native Indian, India Indian.

So we went over to the college, and he was unveiling his newest building. To my surprise, he unveiled a building that was dedicated, and he had a plaque on it with my name on it. He was really moved by that meeting, with all those people's teeth filled and the blind healed.

So you can understand me sitting there and being overwhelmed.

When the Holy Ghost rose up and condemned the meeting in my conscience, I just sat there and bawled later. I said, "Okay, okay," and I walked away telling him I would do the meeting.

When I got home and connected with him by telephone about a month later, I said, "Brother Dhinakaran, I am going to tell you the truth. I was so overpowered in your presence that I knew God did not want me to do that meeting, but I was so overpowered that I just went along. But I cannot."

He said, "I understand."

I said, "If I put \$25,000 anywhere, I am going to put it into your crusade, or I will put it into Rambo's or Brother Prakash's, because these are men we helped train. Not Brother Dhinakaran, but these are men we helped train, and they are on the front line. They have meetings like you have seen in the pictures, with 40,000 and 50,000 being born again in a week."

Now, I can go do that. I can stand up there and call the lost. But God said to me, "Son, you let those men do those meetings that you trained, and you do what I tell you. If you are going to put \$25,000 into anything you are doing over there, put it into the training of the preachers, into the walk of the Spirit and the walk of power. Put it into a package that you can hand them in obscurity, and it will take them from nothing all the way to the power of God."

Well, I understood.

Sometimes it is not the easiest thing. Sometimes the path of glory has been condemned by Him. Time to die. Hallelujah.

After I obeyed Him, He flooded me with revelation. I knew what He had to have me do.

You are not supernatural yourself. You are a supernatural being, a new creation, but you have a conscience that excuses or accuses. To know something outside of you, you have to depend on the Holy Spirit.

The more you walk according to that conscience, the more He will be able to lead you with accuracy.

He does not do this only for the gospel's sake as far as morals. He will condemn bad business deals. He will excuse good ones. With that conscience, with that walk of the inner witness alone, He can steer you in and out of traps.

That is the precious indwelling leadership of the Holy Spirit. The closer you walk with Him, and the less of your life you sear, the greater you will be able to walk according to the inner witness.

Hallelujah, Jesus. Hallelujah.

Now let us go over to the verse that will introduce what God has to work with here.

Romans 8. Thank You, Jesus.

This time we are going to bring you right up to the verse. Can anybody tell me what verse I am probably talking about?

How astounding. Verse 11. You are right. That is ultimately where we are heading.

Even though the bearing witness verse is Romans 8:15:

"For ye have not received the spirit of bondage again to fear;
but ye have received the Spirit of adoption,
whereby we cry, Abba, Father."

You have not received the spirit of bondage again to fear, which is the one Adam gave you when you inherited spiritual death from the first man Adam.

What spirit did I receive? You have received the spirit of adoption. Your human spirit has been translated out of darkness into light. You have literally been adopted by God. Out of that new nature we cry, "You are truly my Father. Abba."

Notice verse 16. This is the first mention of the Holy Spirit in Romans 8, the first mention:

"The Spirit itself beareth witness
with our spirit,
that we are the children of God."

Notice how careful He is to isolate Him: "The Spirit itself." Then notice how careful He is to isolate yours: "with our spirit." There is that witness to the conscience that we have been born again and freed from sin.

Now back up to Romans 8:11:

"But if the Spirit of him
that raised up Jesus from the dead
dwell in you,
he that raised up Christ from the dead
shall also quicken your mortal bodies
by his Spirit that dwelleth in you."

The first two or three times we went through this verse, I mentioned that verse 16 is the first mention of the Holy Spirit. If this is the case, and His Spirit bears witness with ours, then in verse 11, what spirit is He talking about?

What is "the Spirit of Him"?

First, tell me the most popular teaching on it. Which spirit do people usually say the Spirit of Him is?

The Spirit of Him is your born-again human spirit that received the same nature Jesus had in Him when He was the first man to be born spiritually alive in four thousand years.

Then He suffered His death. You were baptized into His death, and you were quickened together with Him. Now the same Spirit of Him, or the one God had put into Christ Jesus, which is your born-again human spirit, if it now dwells in you, then He, back to the Father, will quicken your mortal body by using what?

What does the Father get to use now?

"Well, He is just going to come and do it Himself."

No.

"Well, it is the Holy Spirit."

No, even though He will undoubtedly use Him.

If the same Spirit of Him, the same Spirit of whose? The Father. If the same Spirit of Him, the Father, that He used to raise Jesus from the dead dwells in you, which it does, He says the same thing in verse 2:

"For the law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus
hath made me free
from the law of sin and death."

What is the Spirit of life? It is my born-again human spirit.

What is the law that emanates from it? The new nature has set me free from the law of sin and death, from the death nature of sin that emanated from the spiritually dead nature I had.

The law of the Spirit of life: what is the Spirit of life? It is my born-again human spirit. That is the Spirit of life. The law of that born-again human spirit is a new nature that freed you from sin. That is the law of it. It does not sin inside anymore. It has been freed from the law of sin and death.

That is the law that emanated from my death nature: sin. What freed me from it is replacing it with another law.

But what did He say?

"The law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus."

It is the same one that freed Him from spiritual death when He suffered in our place, and suddenly the life of God came into Him and gave Him His nature back. I was quickened together with Him. The same nature that freed Him freed me.

The law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus has set me free from another law: the law of sin and death.

Now, if you can understand that, you can understand this: if the Spirit of Him that raised Christ from the dead dwells in you, it does.

How do you know?

Because I have been born again.

If the Spirit of Him that raised Christ from the dead dwells in you, He, the Father who raised Christ from the dead, shall also quicken your mortal bodies, bring life to them, by what medium?

What is my Father going to use to quicken my mortal body?

By His Spirit that dwells in you. Meaning, the only thing He has to set you free with is the new nature you received when you were born again. He does not have two things to work with. He only has one.

The way He sets you free is by bringing that law of the Spirit of life forward, for it condemned sin in the flesh and all its friends.

So if the same Spirit of Him that raised Christ Jesus from the dead dwells in you, He, the Father who raised Christ from the dead, will quicken, will bring life to your mortal body, using what medium? By His Spirit that dwells in you.

Not the Holy Spirit. The new nature.

He does not have two things to use. He only has that one thing. If you are defeated, it is because your spirit is weak, undernourished, and God cannot use it.

Can you imagine what praying in tongues does, bypassing your soul, your mind, and your flesh, and bringing out what is in your spirit?

I did not know this, but John G. Lake found this out. I just happened to flip open to it, too. It is a lot to flip. This is all of his works.

Are you ready?

Why can I not get free from my flesh? Because your spirit is still weaker. Inside, it has the freedom. You have been set free.

"Well, why am I not free?"

Because you would still rather walk with the flesh than nourish what He can use to set you free. He does not have two things to free you with, only one:

"By his Spirit that dwelleth in you."

"That is the Holy Spirit."

No, it is not. That is why everybody has been so bound. The Holy Spirit can use that, but if you do not want to be free, He has nothing to use. It is by His Spirit. When your spirit gets to the place through nourishing it, then it is stronger than your disease or your sin, and He will quicken and cleanse you, and you will be free.

John G. Lake said:

"You cannot get healing for the body as far as you are personally concerned. Someone else's faith may, but until your spirit is right, you cannot get healing for your body."

Now, you can get it in a prayer line by somebody else, but usually you cannot keep it.

He said:

"May I call your attention to another thing? Faith is a product of your spirit, not of your intellect. Your intellect does not produce faith. Your knowledge may give you a ground for faith, but faith is resident in the spirit."

Joy, now this is going to sound familiar, is something in your spirit. Happiness is something connected with your surroundings. You are happy because of your surroundings. You are joyful because you are in right relationship with the Father.

Remember how I said that? Joy is a fruit of the Spirit. Happiness is a fruit of joy. I may be in prison, and I will have joy, but I will not be happy about it.

This man is saying the same thing. I am thinking, "My God, he already lived and died. Who told him this? He did not get our tapes."

He also said:

"I want to speak with the utmost frankness concerning that peculiar language that I pray in mostly in the nighttime. I have found it to be the source of the revelation knowledge I teach on a day-by-day basis."

I wonder who told him that.

Happiness is something connected with your surroundings. You are happy because of your surroundings. You are joyful because you are right in your relationship with God.

Faith, love, joy, and hope all spring from the spirit. Being the hidden man of the heart, they are all products of your spiritual life.

The reason people do not have rich, beautiful faith is because their spirit is denied the privilege of communion and fellowship with the Father.

Do you understand me? You do not read your Bible. You do not pore over it. You do not live in it. You do not spend any time fellowshiping with the Father. Consequently, your spirit is depleted and weakened, and faith springs out of it. Your faith grows out of a sickly plant.

On the other hand, your spirit life is fruitful, built up, and enriched by communion with the Father and by reading the Word. That communion includes worship, praying in tongues, and confession. That is what he listed.

He says that on the other hand, your spirit life is fruitful, built up, and enriched by communion with the Father and by reading the Word, and your spirit becomes strong and vigorous. There issues from it faith that is triumphant and creative.

When I was looking down the Born-Again Trail until over two years ago now, I slipped into the Spirit and looked down. To my amazement, everything switched off of the Holy Spirit to the born-again spirit.

He said to me, "Son," and the gift of faith came on me. He said, "Everything that I have ever promised you personally, you will find on this trail. Everything the Word says you can have, you can have, and it is on this trail."

No wonder, if your faith is just one degree off, it can be misguided, and you find yourself beating the air.

But until He opened this chapter up, how could I know that the only thing my Father had to use to quicken my mortal body and drive the sin, flesh, failures, and habitual things out of me was that new nature in me? How could I know that if I would not bring it forward and would not let Him bring it forward, I was destined to a life of defeat?

"For if the same Spirit of him
that raised Christ Jesus from the dead
dwells in you,
he will quicken your mortal body,
bring life to it,
by his Spirit that dwells in you."

You do not have two things to use, just one. When He can bring everything you are, that new creation, that new nature, forward, your soul does not have a chance. Neither does disease. Neither does the flesh. Your soul will think the Titanic ran over it.

This is the basis for all great men who have walked with God. This is why you always found them stealing away, lost somewhere. They did not use their jobs. They did not use anything as excuses. All that was is another mountain that had to go up.

In fact, He likes to train you with the baby mountains in your personal life so that when you get into something serious, you can handle that too, like feeding a nation and nobody has any money. Little things.

Are we going somewhere?

What happens? "I just do not know. How am I going to pray?"

Oh my God, the Holy Ghost is sitting in you with a whole prayer language from heaven, chomping at the bit, saying, "I can bypass all their mess, their flesh, and everything else. I can bring the part of them that He sets them free with forward until one day they wake up and say, 'I am stronger than all of this.'"

You are.

We are going to explore this a little.

I do not know how John G. Lake learned this. It must have been the same Teacher.

Five- or six-year period in Africa? He started 650 churches in five years, ordained 1,225 ministers, and sent them into the bush. He trained them. Spokane, Washington, was declared the most disease-free city in America by the Surgeon General because of John G. Lake's ministry in town.

What is waiting for you?

Oh, for crying out loud. Worship. Speak His Word. Pray in tongues.

He, the Father, will quicken, bring life to every part of your mortal body by His Spirit that dwells in you.

For what the law could not do, in that it was weak through the flesh, God sending His own Son in the likeness of sinful flesh and for sin, condemned sin in the flesh and all its friends.

By the time you get to Romans 8:11, He says He does it by His Spirit that dwells in you.

You cannot stand it either.

Fasting, too. Fasting will help drive your flesh down below the level you are operating in so you can get free. That is something you can do to help the march forward of your born-again spirit.

"How can I help You, Father?"

"You can help by meeting your flesh on the other end and driving it backwards so I can pass it up."